

FORGE Phase 1 · Week 7 · Session 19 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 19: Personal Accountability" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 19 as written runs about 95 minutes. This insert adds two short videos and one talk, which fills the session to two hours without changing any of its content. Week 7 is the most emotionally demanding week so far. The videos are calm and use only cards, graphics and quiet scenes: nothing is acted out.

What's in this insert

- **Video 19A, "Personal Accountability"** (2 min 25 s). The week's turn from skills to character, the four things accountability is not (self-punishment, a performance, an exchange, selective), the guide's definition, and "accountability is liberation: not the consequences, the weight." It ends on the opening check-in question and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 19B, "The Accountability Spectrum"** (2 min 22 s). The five levels one at a time, from denial to full accountability, each with the guide's own examples; the "my background explains it, it doesn't excuse it" example; and why the men who reach Level 5 become the strongest mentors. It ends on the private self-rating ("Where are you on this spectrum? Write the number, 1 through 5, in your journal") and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **A talk:** Quan Huynh, *I was not born a murderer* (TEDxSanQuentin 2022, 15 minutes 22 seconds), with discussion questions. He moves on stage from "It wasn't my fault" to "I'm here for the murder of another human being," which is this session's spectrum lived out.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Video 19A, "Personal Accountability"	3	Play it as soon as the men are seated, with the talking piece in the center.
0:03	Opening Circle	10	As written. Start the round on the question the video ends on. Don't comment on individual answers. Close with the guide's words after the round.
0:13	Instruction: What Accountability Is and Isn't	15	The video has given the four "is nots," the definition and "accountability is liberation." Use the time for discussion: "Which of the four do you see most in here? Which one is yours?" Finish on the two parts: honest acknowledgment and genuine commitment.
0:28	Video 19B, "The Accountability Spectrum" , then the spectrum	20	Keep the spectrum on the board. The video teaches the five levels and ends on the self-rating. When it ends, give the rest of the minute of silence, then say the guide's "Wherever you are is where you start." Spend what's left on how each level sounds in this form (a checklist item).

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:48	Instruction: Guilt vs. Shame	15	As written, including the practical test and "shame thrives in isolation."
1:03	Talk: Quan Huynh, <i>I was not born a murderer</i>	16	Introduce it in one sentence: "He was sentenced to fifteen years to life for murder. Listen to how he talked about it at first, and how he talks about it now."
1:19	Talk discussion	6	Two or three of the questions below are enough.
1:25	Exercise: The Accountability Statement	25	As written: 12 minutes of silent writing, then optional sharing. Quan's "I'm here for the murder of another human being" is Rule 1 in practice: name what you did, specifically, with no "but."
1:50	Closing Circle	10	As written, with both homework items.

Discussion questions for the Quan Huynh talk

1. For about ten years Quan told himself "It wasn't my fault" and "It was my life or theirs." Where on the accountability spectrum do those sentences sit? What moved him off them?
2. When an interviewer asked why he was in prison, everything in him wanted to explain. He stayed quiet, and the longer he did, the more liberated he felt. What does that tell you about "accountability is liberation"?
3. "I committed murder, but I'm not a murderer." Is that guilt or shame talking? Is it an excuse, or is it accountability? Why?
4. He told his mother, "I don't deserve it." Is that self-punishment, or accountability? Where is the line between them?
5. He wrote to the mother of the man he killed, and the letter came back unread. What did writing it do anyway? (*Hold on to this. Session 21's letter is never sent either.*)

Preview the talk before the session. Quan names his crime plainly in his first sentence. He tells briefly how older kids beat his younger brother while he stood by, and how his father died when he was 13. At the end he reads aloud his letter to the mother of the man he killed. There is no graphic imagery, but the room may go quiet. Let it.

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *I was not born a murderer*: **YouTube** (TEDx Talks): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yiyzzM-B6oM> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/quant_huynh_i_was_not_born_a_murderer_quant_huynh_tedxsanquentin

TED's usage policy allows a single talk in a single lesson, with credit. A talk that becomes a standing part of a curriculum "may require a separate license," and TED asks that talks not be scraped from its site. The policy doesn't spell out terms for TEDx talks, which are organized independently. FORGE repeats every cohort and the prison has no internet, so write to TED (help.ted.com, licensing) for an offline copy for a nonprofit, no-fee, in-

prison program. Show it whole and unedited. At the time of the talk Quan Huynh led Defy Ventures' programs in Southern California. Defy is one of the programs FORGE is built on, so Defy is also worth asking.

Check the talk against the facility's rules for outside media before the session.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 19A and 19B and the talk loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Talk previewed and cleared under the facility's media rules
- ☐ The accountability spectrum on the board or handout before Video 19B plays